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Agentic AI for Lead Generation

Partner companies for the Marketing Chair

Tobias Weiß · Guest Lecture · Marketing Chair

Thursday, 22 October 2026 · 15:15–16:00
within "Advanced Issues in Marketing and Sales" (Prof. Haas)

45 minutes · BWL Master students · WS 2026/27 edition

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Why this session exists

- The chair partners with companies: funding, data, cases
- Finding + qualifying partners is manual, slow, unscalable
- Agentic AI can research, score and rank prospects
- **Demo output = evidence for "Sales Strategy and Execution" (SS 2027)**

> Nobody wins from another lecture about chatbots.

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What you will be able to do

By the end…	You can…
Understand	Explain what "agentic" means, and why it is not a chatbot
Operate	Read how a harness (pi) gives an AI tools, rules and a task
Assess	Judge an agentic output: checked? citable? repeatable?
Apply	Reuse the loop from the demo (contract → run → verify) for partner sourcing

> Model = brain. Harness = hands. Workflow = muscles.

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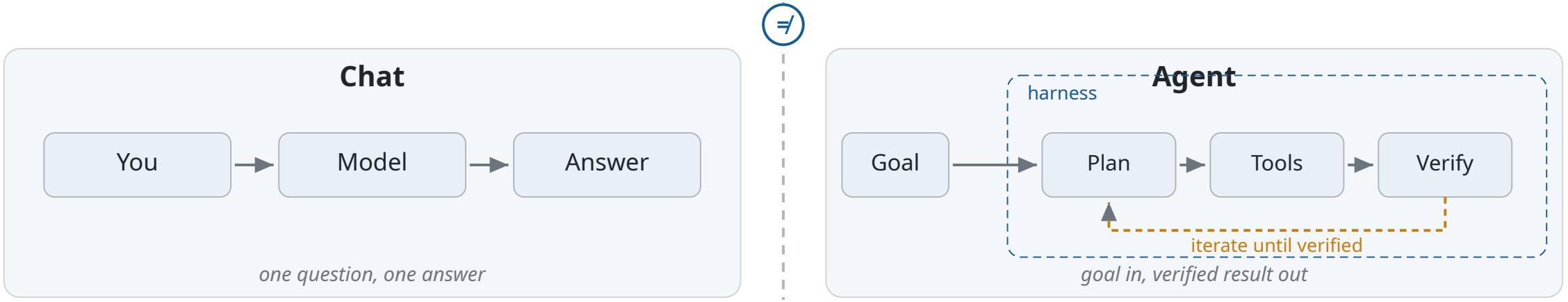
Roadmap — 35 min + 10 min Q&A

Block	Content	Time
1 · Foundations	agentic ≠ chat · model · harness · loop	~8 min
2 · Method	contracts · the lead-gen loop · sector decision · evidence	~7 min
3 · Walkthrough	live demo: contract → agent → verify	~13 min
4 · Reflection	providers · take-aways · resources	~5 min
5 · Q&A	your questions · discussion	10 min

> The walkthrough is the heart — theory is fuel for it. **10 minutes are reserved for your questions.**

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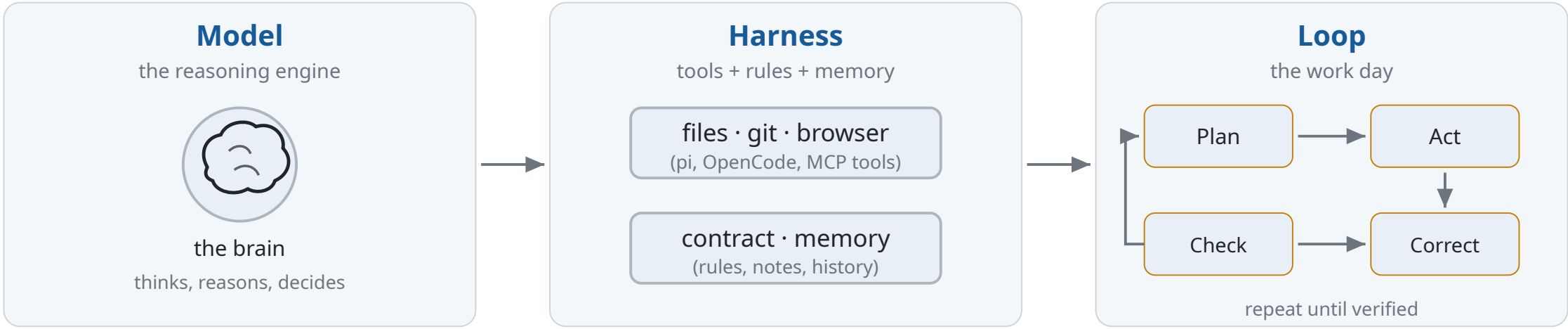
Agentic ≠ chat



> "Agentic" is a working environment — not a better chat.

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The parts: model · harness · loop



Harnesses (2026): pi, OpenCode, Claude Code — same model, different results. The harness decides.

(Full disclosure: pi is my own project — I currently default to it because of its smaller memory footprint; OpenCode and Claude Code are solid alternatives.)

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Why now — the evidence inside the research corpus

13,096 marketing papers · 7,771 published in 2026 alone

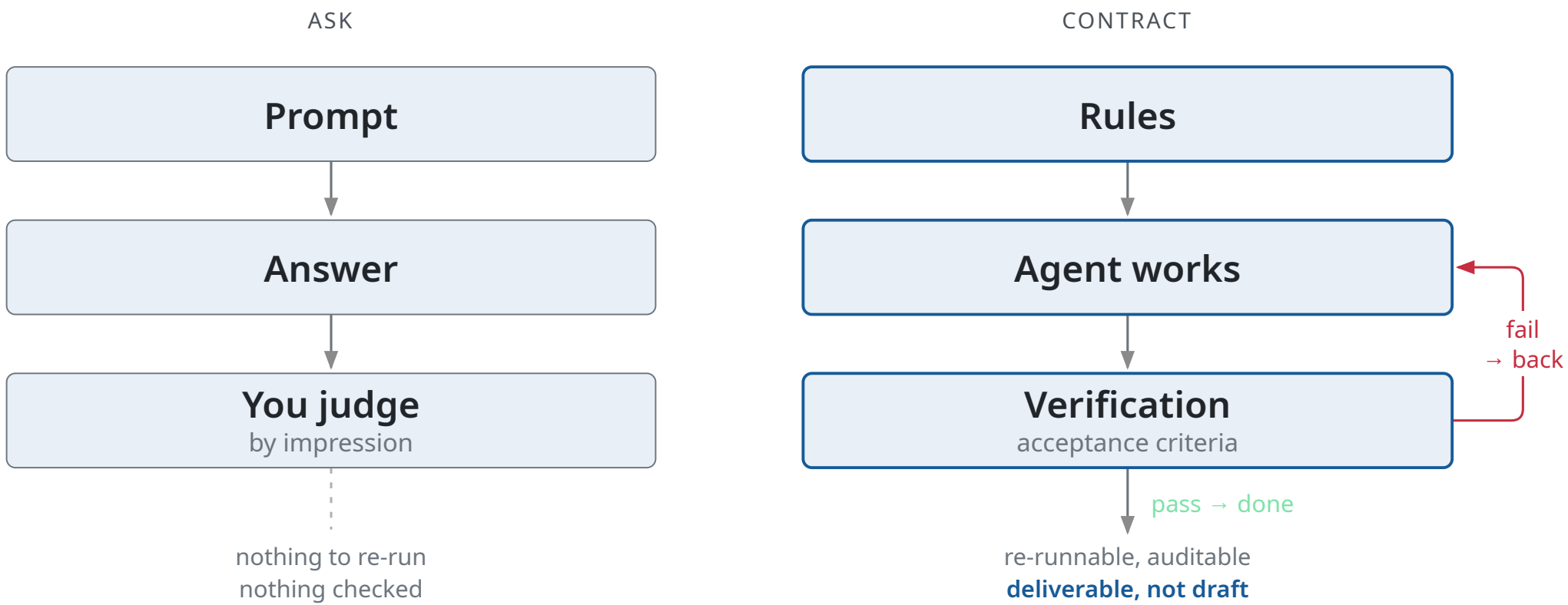
Signal	Count
Papers mentioning **agentic AI**	91
Papers on **lead generation**	27
Both (agentic × lead-gen)	0

Counts: literal keyword search of title + abstract in the chair's open corpus (marketing-research).

> The field is exploding — and in this corpus of 13,096 papers, nobody connects the two yet. This chair can be first.

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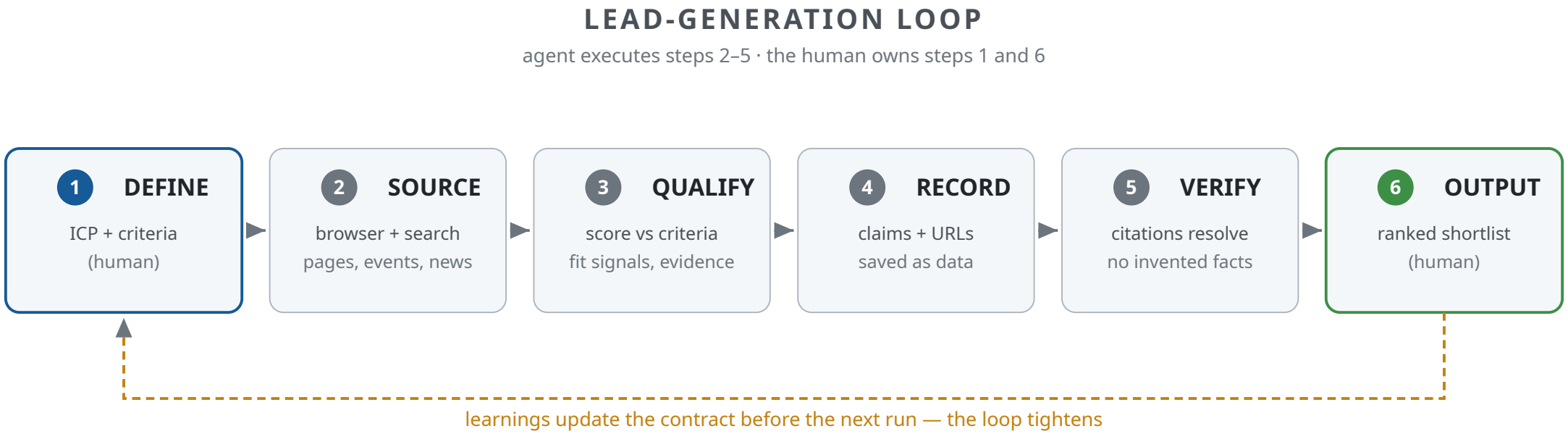
How to talk to the machine: prompts vs contracts



> Prompt = how you ask a chat · Contract = how you run an agent.

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A lead-generation loop as an agentic workflow



> Six steps — the agent executes 2–5, you own definition and evaluation.

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Define the hunt: scoring the sector

Lead generation starts with a **human** decision: *which sector do we hunt?*

Criterion (1–5)	Mech. & plant engineering	Optics / photonics	Grocery retail
Chair research fit — sales management	5	5	2
Course fit — "Sales Strategy and Execution"	5	5	2
Regional employers (Mittelhessen)	5	5	3
Lead-gen relevance — B2B, long cycles	5	4	2
Demo data availability	4	4	5
Total	**24**	**23**	**14**

Hard guard: sector is out if chair fit < 4 **or** lead-gen relevance < 4 — grocery retail (our first default) fails.

Decision: German mechanical & plant engineering.

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Now: a live walkthrough

Task: build the **partner-candidate shortlist** — top 10 B2B companies (live today: 2 of them) with:

- Fit signal per company vs. the chair's partnership goals
- Named source URL per claim (citable, verifiable)
- Ranked output — evidence base for the Bachelor course "Sales Strategy and Execution"

I run this live in a harness — what you see is what the agent does.

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Walkthrough · Step 1 — The contract

```
AGENTS.md / brief (what the agent reads at start)
Goal:      shortlist of 10 B2B partner candidates for the chair
Criteria:  industry fit, innovation agenda, university links
Sources:   company sites, press, funding registries
Output:    ranked list, every claim with a URL
Rules:     no invented facts; if unsure, mark as unverified
```

> Done means: verified, cited, repeatable.

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Walkthrough · Step 2 — The agent at work

Watch the six-step loop run live:

- **only watch** — no magic, every tick is visible in the terminal
- agent **opens the browser** (MCP), reads real company pages
- scores against **the contract** → markdown table with **URLs**
- **iterates**: pause, correct, re-check — that is the loop

> Nothing happens off-screen — the loop is fully visible.

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Walkthrough · Step 3 — The three questions

1. **Checked?** Did the agent verify its output, not just generate it?
2. **Citable?** Does every claim have a URL that resolves — and actually supports it?
3. **Repeatable?** Same contract → same method → a result you can re-run and audit?

The 1–5 scores are a transparent heuristic — each criterion with evidence — not a measurement.

> The final slide of the walkthrough: apply them to the live result.

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What you just saw

1. A contract (rules) — not a prompt
2. An agent doing the loop: plan → act → check → correct
3. A verifiable artefact — the ranked shortlist

That is the method — reusable for any partner-sourcing task.

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What the chair gets out of it

- A reproducible partner-sourcing method (not a one-off search)
- A ranked, sourced shortlist — usable immediately
- Students who can run agentic workflows (a real skill for the CV)
- Evidence base for the **Bachelor course "Sales Strategy and Execution"** (SS 2027)

> The lecture is not the output. The shortlist is.

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Key AI providers — what you can use as a student

Provider / offer	What you get	Where
JLU HRZ API-Service ★	LLMs for all JLU members: free local Qwen models (256K–1M ctx) + commercial, works with OpenCode / Claude Code	uni-giessen.de → HRZ → KI → API-Service · access via **ki@uni-giessen.de**
Google AI student plan	1 year Google AI **Plus** free · Gemini, higher limits, 400 GB	one.google.com/ai-student — verify via SheerID (student status)
OpenRouter	one API key → many models (OpenAI, Anthropic, Google, open) · free models + pay-as-you-go	openrouter.ai
Harnesses	the tools from today's demo — **OpenCode**, pi *(full disclosure: pi is my own project)* — work with any key above	opencode.ai · pi.dev
Local models (Ollama)	free, run on your own laptop, no account, private	ollama.com

> Start with **HRZ API**: free for JLU members · Google deal expires **Dec 31, 2026**.

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Take-aways

1. Agentic = working environment, not a chatbot
2. Harness = model + tools + rules = accountable AI work
3. Contract first: define "done" before you start
4. Verify, cite, repeat — the three questions

> Next summer semester: the chair decides what this evidence feeds into the Bachelor course "Sales Strategy and Execution".

Resources

- **JLU HRZ API-Service** (free LLMs for JLU members) — uni-giessen.de → HRZ → KI → API-Service · model overview
- **HRZ access one-pager** (student quick start, 1 page) — `hrz-access-one-pager.md`
- **pi** — pi.dev · docs: pi.dev/docs *(full disclosure: my own project)* · **OpenCode** — opencode.ai · **OpenRouter** (one key, many models) — openrouter.ai
- **Google AI student plan** — one.google.com/ai-student (1 year free for students)
- **marketing-research** (chair corpus, public) — github.com/tobias-weiss-ai-xr/marketing-research
- **skeleton-research** (forkable corpus skeleton) — github.com/tobias-weiss-ai-xr/skeleton-research
- **This deck** — `lecture/` in this corpus repo (English, 45 min)

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Thank you!

Questions?

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Agentic AI for Lead Generation · 22 Oct 2026 · 45 min